

On December 12, 1911 A.D., the announcement of carving out Bihar as a separate province from Bengal was made at the Delhi Durbar. On 22 March, 1912 A.D. Bihar and Orissa province was proclaimed to be formed out of Bengal and it came into existence on 1 April, 1912 A.D. In 1936 A.D., Bihar became a separate province.

Lucknow Session of Congress **(The Lucknow Pact)**

*In **December 1916 AD**, both Indian National Congress and Muslim League held their sessions at Lucknow.

*Both parties passed separate resolutions on demands for constitutional reforms and agreed on a pact to work together in the political field on a common programme. This is known as **Lucknow Pact** or **Congress-League Programme**. ***Ambika Charan Majumdar** was president of Congress in this session. As a result, they together released 19 bulletins to give a positive direction to the contemporary political scenario. *Lucknow session was very significant due to two reasons, first, the Extremists who were expelled from Congress nine years ago (in 1907 A.D.) were again merged to Congress and, secondly there was a pact between Congress and League. **Annie Besant** and **Tilak** played a significant role in the return of Extremists to Congress. On the other hand, the efforts of Jinnah and Tilak were responsible for Congress-League Pact. The period from 1916 A.D. to 1922 A.D. was the time of consensus between Congress and League. Lucknow Pact was just a temporary arrangement. Muslim League, besides this pact had its own identity and it advocated for the interests of Muslims where ever possible. Both League and Congress were together until 1922 A.D.

1. In December, 1916 both Indian National Congress and Indian Muslim League held their session at:

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|-------------|---------------|
| (a) Aligarh | (b) Allahabad |
| (c) Lucknow | (d) Lahore |

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

An important step towards achieving Hindu-Muslim unity was the Lucknow Pact, 1916 A.D. Anti-British feelings were generated among the Muslims following a war between Britain and Turkey, which opened the way for Congress and Muslim League unity. Both the Congress and the Muslim League held sessions at Lucknow in 1916 A.D. This meeting settled the details of an agreement on the composition of the legislatures and the quantum of representation to be allowed to the two communities. The agreement was confirmed by the annual sessions of the Congress, and the League held at Lucknow on 29 and 31 December, 1916 A.D. respectively.

The Congress accepted the separate electorates and both organizations jointly demanded dominion status for the country. Hindu-Muslim unity weakened the British attitude. In 1916 A.D., the British Government announced a policy whereby the involvement of Indians in the Government was to be increased, and there was to be a gradual development of local self-Government institutions. Sarojini Naidu described Jinnah, the chief architect of the Lucknow Pact, with the title of the 'Ambassador of Hindu-Muslim Unity.'

2. The Lucknow Session of Indian National Congress that took place in 1916 was presided over by:

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|-------------------|---------------------|
| (a) Annie Besant | (b) Lala Lajpat Rai |
| (c) Motilal Nehru | (d) A.C. Majumdar |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

In 1916 A.D., A.C. Majumdar presided over the Lucknow Session, where famous Lucknow Pact was signed.

3. The famous 'Lucknow Pact' was signed between the Congress and Muslim League in:

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|----------|----------|
| (a) 1913 | (b) 1914 |
| (c) 1915 | (d) 1916 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

4. Who among the following was the chief architect or reconciliation between the Extremists and the Moderates?

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|------------------|----------------------|
| (a) Annie Besant | (b) M.A. Jinnah |
| (c) Madam Cama | (d) Feroz Shah Mehta |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

In 1916 A.D., the Lucknow session of Indian National Congress presided by Ambika Charan Majumdar was remarkable in two visions. First, extremists evicted from Indian National Congress for 9 years re-entered in Congress and second, the agreement between Congress and the Muslim League. Both Annie Besant and Tilak tried their best to make a compromise with the moderates for re-establishing the unity within the Congress by taking the extremists back into Congress. Muhammad Ali Jinnah and Tilak were the main architects of the Lucknow Pact.

5. Who made the agreement between Muslim League and Congress in 1916?

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| (a) B. G. Tilak | (b) Gokhle |
| (c) Annie Besant | (d) J. L. Nehru |